



Standing Apart: In a world of AI, ATS, ghosting, and steep role requirements how to stand apart.

By: Brad Voris

Brad Voris, Security Guy

- Security Professional
(Engineer/Manager/Architect)
- 26+ years of experience IT/IS/CS
- Undergrad in Cybersecurity @ Wilmington University
- Certifications: CISSP, CISM, CCSP, CCSK, TAISE, Network+, MTA, MCP, etc.
- Co-Author 2 books: Intrusion Detection Guide and Essentials of Cybersecurity for Peerlyst
- Cloud Security Alliance Zero Trust Training Contributor
- Peer Reviewer, Editor and Collaborator on numerous articles, books and whitepapers...
- **NOT AN EXPERT**





AI: What has AI done for recruiting?

AI is still in its infant stages for recruiting:

- Sourcing candidates
- Job Descriptions
- Resume Screening (w/alignment to ATS)
- Interview Support
- Data Analytics

AI cannot determine your cultural fit, leadership potential, integrity, creativity or adaptability.





ATS: Applicant Tracking Systems



ATS primarily look for key indicators that align to the role you are applying for with in your resume:

- Keywords
- Job Titles
- Skills
- Certifications
- Experience



ATS isn't deterministic, its allowing recruiters to deal with an overwhelming number of resumes that current systems cannot accommodate.

This is what recruiters see...

- Doesn't meet the educational requirements...
- Doesn't meet the skill requirements...
- Doesn't meet the certification requirements...
- Doesn't meet the experience requirements...
- Poorly formatted resume...
- Misspellings in resume...
- Multiple short stays at roles for less than one year...
- Gaps on your resume...
- Incomplete job application...



What you and I see...

We appreciate the time you took to submit your application for the position you applied for. After careful consideration, we regret to inform you

Thanks very much for your interest



. We wanted to inform you that at this time we will not be moving forward with your candidacy.



Dice



In the meantime, we wish you success with your job search and in your career.

At this time, we have decided to proceed with another candidate who more closely aligns with our needs for this opening.

This volume of response makes for an extremely competitive selection process.



We regret to tell you, however, that we won't be moving forward with your candidacy. We realize a lot of time and effort goes into the application process, and we greatly appreciate your time and consideration. We'll keep your information on file and will reach out to you when another opportunity arises.

Dear [not available]

Thank you for submitting your application to [not available] - Manager -Cyber Compliance at [not available] .

We wanted to reach out to let you know that your application is still active and under review. We appreciate your patience as we are currently assessing all candidates for the next steps in the process.

We will maintain regular contact with you as we carefully consider your application for this position. You may also check the status of your applications at any time by logging into your Candidate Home Account.

What will help... CAPABILITY

- **KNOW WHAT YOU WANT TO DO**
- **SHOW** what you know and what you are capable of...
- **Create a portfolio** of your work: Technical writing, Github projects, diagrams, educational content, LinkedIn articles, etc.
- Documented Labs
- Share your content with other people...

What will help... **ENGAGEMENT**

- Get a **MENTOR**
- **Networking** not just LinkedIn but meeting people at meetups, conferences (like CYBR.SEC.CON, bSides, HAHA, Etc.)
- **Connecting** with hiring managers, HR recruiters, and reaching out for roles you want
- **Engaging with people and content** on LinkedIn and other platforms (Post something Weekly, because visibility is crucial)
- Get help with your **resume**, doesn't mean you have to pay but work with hiring managers to determine what they are looking for
- **Referrals** have a better success rate than blind applications

What will help... DIVERSIFY

- The EASY APPLY button isn't going to save you
- Spread resume across multiple platforms
- Utilize 3rd party recruiters and recruiting systems
- Contract and contract to hire roles will likely get your foot in the door

What will help... EDUCATE

- Focus on educating yourself
 - Obtain certifications that are relevant to what you want to do
- Skill yourself up with labs and online classes
- Align your skills and resume to roles that you are better suited for

What employers want today...

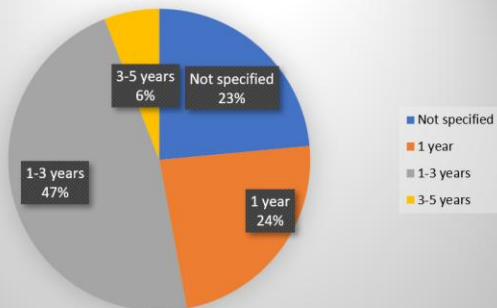
- Experience: 1-3 years
 - Education: Bachelor's Degree (Information/Cybersecurity Related)
 - Skills: Soft Skills, Endpoint Security, Intrusion Detection, Governance
 - Certification: Security+, CySa+, CISA, CISSP, GCIH, GSEC
-
- Leadership
 - Tenacity
 - Determination
 - Agility



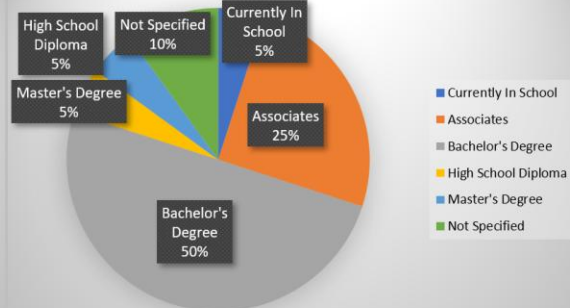
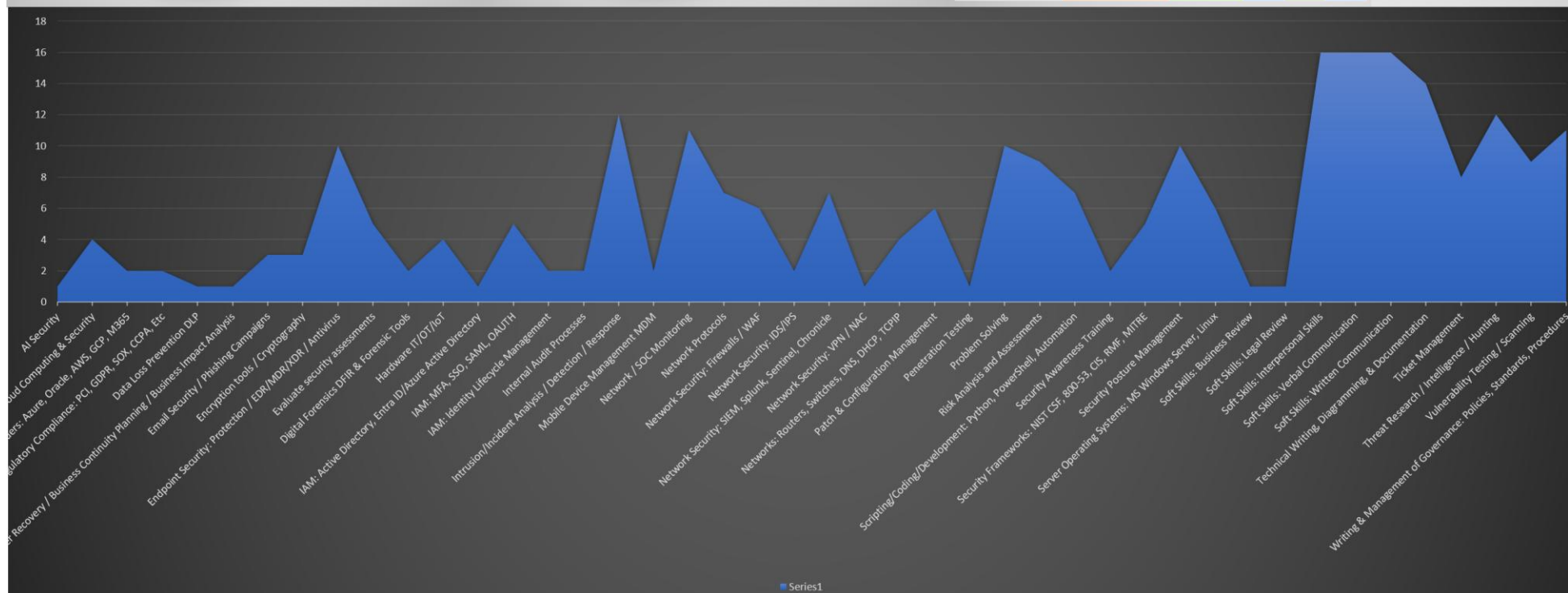
2026 Security Analyst Research

Security Analyst - Analysis

Job Experience Requirements / Preference



Job Education Requirements / Preference

**Job Certification Requirements / Preference**

A letter to employers...

Thank you for the time and effort that you and your organization invested throughout the interview process. I truly appreciate the opportunity to meet with the team and participate in the numerous interviews, the one-hour presentation, and screening discussions.

After careful consideration, I have decided to move forward with another organization whose opportunity aligns more closely with my current career goals and personal needs.

I understand how competitive your selection process is, and with that in mind, I regret to inform you that your organization was not selected. While this may come as a surprise, I hope you can appreciate the irony after the thorough evaluation process we both experienced.

I will certainly keep your organization in mind for future opportunities and would not hesitate to recommend you to colleagues should the right situation arise.

Thank you again for your time, professionalism, and consideration. I wish you and your team continued success and the very best in finding the right candidate for the role.

